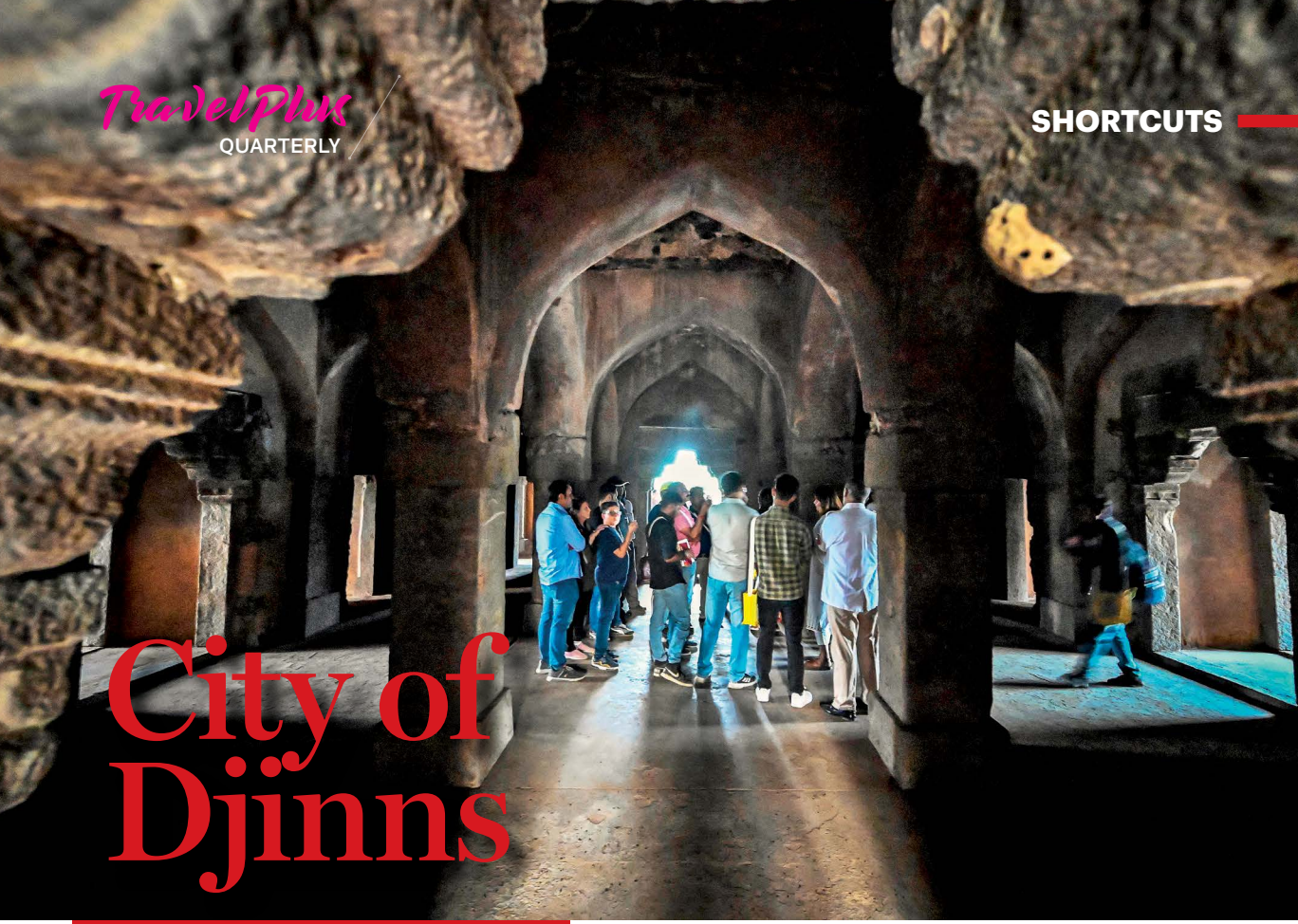


GETTY IMAGES

City of Djinns

With its storied past and rich legacy of built heritage, Delhi has always been a haunt for heritage walks. And, as of May this year, 'haunted' heritage walks are on the menu too. Launched by Delhi Tourism, two such walks are currently on offer: 'Malcha Mahal' and 'Feroz Shah Kotla'. The first walk takes in Malcha Mahal, a Tughlaq-era hunting lodge set inside the ridge in Central Delhi. From 1985, the dilapidated building was home to Begum Wilayat Mahal, who claimed to be the great-granddaughter of Wajid Ali Shah, and her two children. In 1993, she committed suicide allegedly by swallowing crushed diamonds. Inevitably, some say her spirit haunts the place. The second walk starts at Khooni Darwaza and takes in Feroz Shah Kotla, said to be the abode of djinns after dark. Believers tie threads to the trees and gates here and make a wish. We just wish that the quirky walks keep coming.

The walks run every Saturday and Sunday and cost Rs 800 per person. They are 1.5 hours long (5.30-7 pm) and can be booked on delhitourism.gov.in. Children below the age of 15 are not allowed.



DEBAJYOTI CHAKRABORTY

LET THERE BE LIGHT

A newly launched sound-and-light show at Kolkata's Victoria Memorial Hall uses 3D projection mapping to bring the story of Kolkata to life. Titled 'Kolkata-The City of Joy', the 40-minute show was inaugurated by Union home minister Amit Shah on Rabindra Jayanti, which according to the Bengali calendar fell on May 9 this year. From babus of yore to food, culture, literature and history, the show delves into all things Kolkata, past and present, in an engaging and accessible manner.

The show runs on all days except Mondays and public holidays and is being projected in English (Wednesday), Bengali (Tuesday/ Friday/ Sunday) and Hindi (Thursday/ Saturday). Timings: 6.30 pm. Ticket: Rs 100 (museum entry ticket extra).